

[Verse 1]

G D/F# Em Am C
A long, long time ago, I can still remember
Em D
How that music used to make me smile
G D/F# Em
And I knew if I had my chance
Am C
That I could make those people dance
Em C D
And maybe they'd be happy for a while
Em Am Em Am
But February made me shiver, with every paper I'd deliver
C G6/B Am Em D
Bad news on the doorstep, I couldn't take one more step
G D/F# Em C D
I can't remember if I cried, when I read about his widowed bride
G D/F# Em C D G
But something touched me deep inside the day the music died

[Chorus]

G C G D
So bye, bye Miss American Pie
G C G D
Drove my Chevy to the levee but the levee was dry
G C G D
Them good old boys were drinking whiskey and rye
Em A7
Singing this'll be the day that I die
Em D7
This'll be the day that I die

[Verse 2]

G Am
Did you write the book of love
C Am
And do you have faith in God above
Em D
If the Bible tells you so?
G D/F# Em
Now do you believe in rock and roll?
Am C
Can music save your mortal soul?
Em A7 D
And can you teach me how to dance real slow?
Em D
Well, I know that you're in love with him
Em D
'Cause I saw you dancing in the gym
C G Am
You both kicked off your shoes
C D
Man, I dig those rhythm and blues
G D/F# Em
I was a lonely teenage broncin' buck
Am C
With a pink carnation and a pickup truck
G D/F# Em
But I knew I was out of luck
C D G
The day the music died

[Chorus]

G C G D

I started singing bye, bye Miss American Pie Drove
 my Chevy to the levee but the levee was dry
 Them good old boys were drinking whiskey and rye
 Singing this'll be the day that I die
 This'll be the day that I die

[Verse 3]

Now, for ten years we've been on our own
 And moss grows fat on a rolling stone
 But that's not how it used to be
 When the jester sang for the king and queen
 In a coat he borrowed from James Dean
 And a voice that came from you and me
 Oh, and while the king was looking down
 The jester stole his thorny crown
 The courtroom was adjourned
 No verdict was returned
 And while Lennin read a book on Marx
 The quartet practiced in the park
 And we sang 'Dirges In The Dark'
 The day the music died

[Chorus]

We were singing bye, bye Miss American Pie Drove
 my Chevy to the levee but the levee was dry
 Them good old boys were drinking whiskey and rye
 Singing this'll be the day that I die
 This'll be the day that I die

[Verse 4]

Helter skelter in a summer swelter
 The birds flew off with a fallout shelter
 Eight miles high and falling fast
 Landed foul on the grass
 The players tried for a forward pass
 With the jester on the sidelines in a cast

Em D
 Now the half time air was sweet perfume
 Em D
 While sergeants played a marching tune
 C G Am
 We all got up to dance
 C D
 Oh, but we never got the chance
 G D/F# Em
 'Cause the players tried to take the field
 Am C
 The marching band refused to yield
 G D/F# Em
 Do you recall what was revealed
 C D G
 The day the music died?

[Chorus]

G C G D
 We started singing bye, bye Miss American Pie Drove
 G C G D
 my Chevy to the levee but the levee was dry
 G C G D
 Them good old boys were drinking whiskey and rye
 Em A7
 Singing this'll be the day that I die
 Em D7
 This'll be the day that I die

[Verse 5]

G Am
 Oh, and there we were all in one place
 C Am
 A generation lost in space
 Em D
 With no time left to start again
 G D/F# Em
 So come on Jack be nimble, Jack be quick
 Am C
 Jack Flash sat on a candlestick
 Em A7 D
 'Cause fire is the devil's only friend
 Em D
 Oh, and as I watched him on the stage
 Em D
 My hands were clenched in fists of rage
 C G Am
 No angel born in hell
 C D
 Could break that Satan's spell
 G D/F# Em
 And as the flames climbed high into the night
 Am C
 To light the sacrificial rite
 G D/F# Em
 I saw Satan laughing with delight
 C D G
 The day the music died

[Chorus]

G C G D
 He was singing bye, bye Miss American Pie Drove
 G C G D
 my Chevy to the levee but the levee was dry
 G C G D

Them good old boys were drinking whiskey and rye
Em A7
Singing this'll be the day that I die
Em D7
This'll be the day that I die

[Verse 6]

G D/F# Em
I met a girl who sang the blues
Am C
And I asked her for some happy news
Em D
But she just smiled and turned away
G D/F# Em
I went down to the sacred store
Am C
Where I'd heard the music years before
Em C D
But the man there said the music wouldn't play
Em Am
And in the streets the children screamed
Em Am
The lovers cried and the poets dreamed
C G6/B Am
But not a word was spoken
C D
The church bells all were broken
G D/F# Em
And the three men I admire most
C D
The Father, Son and the Holy Ghost
G D/F# Em
They caught the last train for the coast
C D G
The day the music died

[Chorus]

G C G D
And they were singing bye, bye Miss American Pie
G C G D
Drove my Chevy to the levee but the levee was dry
G C G D
Them good old boys were drinking whiskey and rye
Em A7
Singing this'll be the day that I die
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